

dwl + tmux — key reference

elster · source of truth: packages/dwl/config.h, dotfiles/tmux/config.conf

Super = Win/Logo key — everything with Super goes to **dwl** (the compositor).
Ctrl / **Ctrl+Shift** / **Alt** chords without Super go to **tmux** (no prefix needed). The tmux prefix is **Ctrl+Shift+B**; it is only needed for the few **prefix ...** bindings.
Every foot window is a tmux client, so "terminal" below means foot + tmux.

dwl · launching

Super+Alt+T	new terminal window (foot + tmux)
Super+D / Super+P	app launcher (fuzzel)
Super+Alt+F	file manager (thunar)
Super+C	calculator (fuzzel; result goes to the clipboard)
Super+V	clipboard history (cliphist)
Super+Alt+W	wifi menu (nmcli via fuzzel)
Super+Esc	power menu
Super+L	lock screen (swaylock)
Super+Shift+Q	quit dwl
Ctrl+Alt+F7..F12	switch virtual terminal

dwl · windows and focus

Super+J / Super+K	focus next / previous window in the stack
Super+Shift+J / Super+Shift+K	move window down / up the stack
Super+Enter	zoom — make the focused window the master (swap with master)
Super+Shift+C	close window
Super+E	toggle fullscreen
Super+Shift+Space	toggle floating
Super+Tab	back to the previously viewed tags (toggle back and forth)
Super+Left mouse	drag window
Super+Middle mouse	toggle floating
Super+Right mouse	resize window

dwl · two monitors

Super+, / Super+.	focus the left / right monitor
Super+Shift+< / Super+Shift+>	send window to the left / right monitor

Each monitor has its own set of tags. **Super+1..9** switches tags on the monitor that has focus; the bar on each monitor shows that monitor's tags.

dwl · tags 1..9 (workspaces)

<code>Super+1..9</code>	view tag N
<code>Super+Ctrl+1..9</code>	also view tag N (several tags at once)
<code>Super+Shift+1..9</code>	move window to tag N
<code>Super+Ctrl+Shift+1..9</code>	window also visible on tag N (toggle)
<code>Super+0</code>	view all tags
<code>Super+Shift+0</code>	window on all tags

A tag is not a workspace in the strict sense: a window can live on several tags and a monitor can show several tags at once. In the bar: the viewed tag is highlighted, occupied tags are bright, empty ones are dimmed, urgent ones red.

dwl · layouts

<code>Super+T</code>	tile <code>[]=</code> — auto: landscape monitor → master left, stack right; portrait monitor → master on top, stack below
<code>Super+F</code>	floating <code>><></code>
<code>Super+M</code>	monocle <code>[M]</code> (one window at a time)
<code>Super+Space</code>	switch between the two most recent layouts
<code>Super+I</code>	+1 window in the master area
<code>Super+Shift+D</code>	−1 window in the master area
<code>Super+H</code> / <code>Super+Shift+L</code>	master area smaller / larger (±5%)

Layout mode: `Super+R`, then keys *without Super*, `Esc` to leave

A layout badge appears at the left of the bar while the mode is active. Keys not listed here do nothing until you leave the mode.

<code>←</code> / <code>→</code>	+1 / −1 window in the master area (stays in the mode — press repeatedly)
<code>Shift+←</code> / <code>Shift+→</code>	master area smaller / larger (stays in the mode)
<code>t</code> / <code>f</code> / <code>m</code>	tile (auto by monitor shape) / floating / monocle — leaves the mode
<code>b</code>	bstack <code>TTT</code> — force master on top, stack below — leaves the mode
<code>Shift+F</code>	toggle floating on the focused window — leaves the mode
<code>Esc</code>	leave the mode

Typical: `Super+R`, `Shift+→` ×3, `Esc`.

dwl · screenshots and recording

<code>Print</code>	whole screen → clipboard
<code>Super+Print</code>	takeshot: whole screen → file + clipboard + notification
<code>Super+Alt+S</code>	takeshot: select area (slurp) → file + clipboard + notification
<code>Super+Shift+S</code>	select area → clipboard only (no file)
<code>Super+Alt+R</code>	recorder: select area → mp4. Press again, or click REC in the bar, to stop

From the takeshot notification: Edit (satty — arrows, lines, text, pixelate, blur) / Open / Copy PNG. Files land in ~/Pictures/Screenshots and ~/Videos/Recordings.

dwl · notifications (mako)

Notification mode: `Super+Alt+N`, then one key

<code>h</code>	show the last dismissed notification
<code>a</code>	invoke the notification's default action
<code>c</code>	dismiss one
<code>Shift+C</code>	dismiss all

All of these are one-shot: they return to normal mode immediately.

dwl · bar (waybar) and media keys

<code>Super+B</code>	show / hide the bar
click REC	stop recording
click bell / right-click bell	toggle do-not-disturb / dismiss all notifications
click wifi / bluetooth	wifi menu / bluetui
volume: click / right-click / scroll	mute / pwvucontrol / volume
brightness: scroll	brightness
<code>XF86 Vol±</code> / <code>Mute</code>	volume (avizo on-screen display)
<code>XF86 Brightness±</code>	brightness

tmux · panes

<code>Ctrl+Shift+Enter</code>	new pane (split). <code>Super+Shift+Enter</code> does the same — dwl passes it through
<code>Ctrl+Shift+W</code>	close pane (layout re-applied)
<code>Ctrl+←</code> <code>Ctrl+↑</code> <code>Ctrl+↓</code> <code>Ctrl+→</code>	focus the pane in that direction
<code>Ctrl+N</code> / <code>Ctrl+P</code>	next / previous pane (passed to vim / fzf when they are running)
<code>Ctrl+Shift+N</code> / <code>Ctrl+Shift+P</code>	swap pane with the next / previous one
<code>Ctrl+Enter</code>	swap pane into the master slot (top-left)
<code>Ctrl+Shift+←↑↓→</code>	resize pane by 4 cells
<code>Ctrl+Shift+F</code>	zoom pane to the whole window / back
<code>Ctrl+Alt+Enter</code>	break pane out into its own window
<code>Ctrl+Alt+G</code>	split with a shell behind proxychains (ghost@ prompt)
<code>Ctrl+F4</code>	show pane numbers
<code>Ctrl+Shift+F4</code>	show pane numbers, then press one to swap with it
prefix <code>p</code>	fuzzy pane picker with preview (sk)
prefix <code>y</code> / <code>Y</code>	synchronised input to all panes on / off

Layout mode: `Ctrl+Shift+L`, then one key

<code>v</code>	main-vertical — master left, stack right
<code>h</code>	main-horizontal — master on top, stack below

t	tilled — equal grid
f	zoom pane

After every split tmux picks the layout from the window shape, same rule as dwl's tile: wide window → main-vertical, tall (portrait monitor) window → main-horizontal. The keys above override it for the current window.

tmux · windows and sessions

Ctrl+Shift+T	new window (inserted after the current one, same directory)
Ctrl+Shift+Q	close window (asks for confirmation if it has more than one pane)
Alt+1..9	go to window N
Ctrl+, / Ctrl+.	previous / next window
Ctrl+Shift+< / Ctrl+Shift+>	move window left / right
prefix s	session picker (sesh). Inside: Tab / Shift+Tab move, Ctrl+A all, Ctrl+T tmux only, Ctrl+G configs, Ctrl+X zoxide dirs, Ctrl+F find dir, Ctrl+D kill session
prefix L	last session

tmux · scrollback and copy

Ctrl+Shift+PgUp / PgDn	scroll history one page (passed to vim / less when running)
Ctrl+Shift+Home / End	jump to top / bottom of history
Ctrl+Shift+K	clear screen and history
v	copy-mode: start selection
Ctrl+V	copy-mode: toggle rectangle selection
y	copy-mode: copy and leave
Ctrl+Shift+F5	reload tmux.conf

Copy mode uses vi keys (mode-keys vi). Mouse is off in tmux — select text with the keyboard.